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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP(Honours)/MGU-BBA(Honours)/MGU-BCA (Honours)
REGULAR EXAMINATION, MARCH 2025
SECOND SEMESTER
Ability Enhancement Courses (AEC) –
MG2AECENG102 – ENGLISH FOR COMMERCE - PART II
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

SCHEME OF VALUATION

Part A

MCQ

Answer all questions **Each question carries 1 mark** **[1x5 = 5]**

1. Why must the river enter the ocean despite its fear? [U] / [CO1]

a). To end its journey b). To avoid the mountains
c). To stop flowing **d). To overcome fear and become part of something larger**

Answer: d). To overcome fear and become part of something larger

2. Identify the vowel sound of these words: all, four [U] / [CO1]

a). /ɒ/ **b). /ɔ:/** c). /e/ d). /æ/

Answer: b). /ɔ:/

3. Howdoes the mysterious visitor behave before entering the White family's home? [K] / [CO1]

a). He walks in confidently. **b). He looks uncertain and hesitates.**
c). He angrily knocks on the door. d). He leaves without entering.

Answer: b). He looks uncertain and hesitates.

4. Which of the following words begins with the /ʧ/ sound? [U] / [CO1]

a). Game **b). Chair** c). Map d). Desk

Answer: b). Chair

5. Which word contains the consonant sound /ʃ/? [U] / [CO1]

a). yes b). which c). genre **d). machine**

Answer: d). machine

Part B

SHORT ANSWER

Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks **[5x6 = 30]**

6. You are waiting outside the interview room along with another candidate. Start a friendly conversation to ease the tension. [A] / [CO3]

Expected Response:

1. Use of the IRSF (Initiate, Respond, Sustain and Follow up) pattern
2. Structure: Good opening, sustaining and closing
3. Language appropriate for a casual conversation
4. Answer to be a response to the situation given

5. Due weightage to correctness of language used (Page 22)

7. In "How Watson Learned the Trick," Dr Watson attempts to use Sherlock Holmes's methods of deduction but ultimately fails. Discuss with examples from the text. [U] / [CO1]

Expected Response: An appropriate discussion based on

1) **Unshaven face** → "You were greatly **pre- occupied** when you got up this morning."
2) Groan after reading an **envelope** addressed to "Barlow" → "You have a **client named Barlow** and you have not been successful with his case."
3) Turning at once to the **financial page and exclaiming** loudly → "You have taken to financial **speculation**."
4) Wearing a **black coat** instead of a dressing- gown at breakfast →"You are expecting some important **visitor** at once." (Pages 78-80)

8. Complete the sentences using appropriate modal auxiliary verbs: [A] / [CO2]

A. Employees _____ follow the company rules. (Obligation)
Answer: Must/should/ought to
B. Suresh _____ solve complex math problems easily as a child. (Ability in the past)
Answer: could
C. Their flight _____ have landed by now. (Probability) **Answer**: Might
D. You _____ wear a seatbelt while driving. (Advice) **Answer**: should/ ought to
E. I _____ come to your party, but I am not sure yet. (Possibility)
Answer:may/ can / could

9. Write a telephone conversation between a passenger and a taxi service to book a cab for airport transfer. [A] / [CO3]

Expected Response shall include at least two speaker altogether.
Client 'Introducing yourself' – taxi service rep expressing wish to help -- expressions appropriate for making requests – asking for something – giving help – giving details-- finishing the conversation.
(Pages 39-41)

10. Analyse the symbolic use of imagery in the poem "A Psalm of Life", such as "muffled drums", "footprints on the sands of time", and the "broad field of battle". How does it contribute to the poem's theme of perseverance and meaningful existence? [An] / [CO1]

Expected response should include –

- Longfellow's muffled funeral drums urge urgency;
- footprints on shifting sands promise lasting influence;
- the world's broad battle- field frames life as struggle
- Together, images demand courageous action and persevering, purposeful existence.

(Page 46)

11. Add the correct question tag to complete each sentence: [A] / [CO2]

a. I am your friend, _____?
b. Kiran seldom visits his parents, _____?
c. Pass me the salt, _____?
d. Everyone is present, _____?

e. They don't like spicy food, _____?

Answer:

a. I am your friend, **aren't I?**
b. Kiran seldom visits his parents, **does he?**
c. Pass me the salt, **will you?**
d. Everyone is present, **aren't they?**
e. They don't like spicy food, **do they?**

12. Construct grammatically correct Yes/No questions for the following statements: [A] / [CO2]

i. The employees have submitted their reports.
ii. She was driving to the office when the call came.
iii. They will attend the training session next week.
iv. The company offers flexible work hours.
v. He had already emailed the client.

Answer:

i. Have the employees submitted their reports?
ii. Was she driving to the office when the call came?
iii. Will they attend the training session next week?
iv. Does the company offer flexible work hours?
v. Had he already emailed the client?

13. What are some of the common language mistakes highlighted by Shashi Tharoor in the interview? [U] / [CO1]

Expected Response: An ideal answer may include 4 broad points substantiated with examples – at least 3 with examples can be given 5 marks.**(Pages 94-97)**

1) Vocabulary – wrong meaning – Outdated (Victorian / Indian- office jargon)
2) Unnecessary adverb- forming "- ly"
3) Pronunciation mistakes (plumber, hyperbole, epitome etc)
4) Consonant confusion (V ↔ W)

14. Compare and contrast a debate and a group discussion. [U] / [CO3]

Expected Response: Relevant pages in the text: P 64-71

Comparison to be made in terms of (1) Primary Purpose (2) Stance of Participants (3) Typical Outcome- declaration of winner (4) Atmosphere & Tone (5) Structure & Rules (6) Evaluation criteria (7) Role of moderator (8) Preparation Required (9) Communication Skills Highlighted. (Pages 54-71)

A proper comparison in terms of any 5 aspects listed above can be given full marks.

Part C

ESSAY

Answer any 1 question. Each question carries 15 marks. [15x1 = 15]

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15. Suppose you are a commerce student attending an interview for a Sales Manager post. Prepare a sample interview conversation. [A] / [CO3]

Expected answer to include appropriate questions and reasonable responses – the interaction should suit the vacancy called for. (pages: 55-57)

16. Prepare a group discussion with six participants on the topic "Women in leadership: challenges and opportunities ". [A] / [CO3]

Expected Response:
To include responses to the topic from 6 speakers – opinion based GD but factual details can be included –speakers to demonstrate communication skills – could ideally be solution focused – reaching a consensus towards the end. (pages: 64-68)

17. Draft a job application letter for the position of Financial Analyst in a banking institution. Assume you have recently completed your MBA in Finance. Include a résumé as an attachment. [A] / [CO3]

Expected response:

1. Cover letter: An appropriate Header, subject Line, Salutation, Opening para mentioning reason for interest – Body giving main content demonstrating suitability – Closing para (enthusiasm, willingness, and expression of gratitude) – Complementary close and signature – enclosures.-- Refer to the example (pages: 73-74)
2. Resume: Contact Info – Professional summary – Education in reverse chronology – Professional experience – skills – certifications – projects – volunteer experience – reference (in this order) (Pages: 74-75)